

Amazon offers a number of solutions to maintaining and storing your databases. Let us take a look at them one by one.

Bare Linux Machines as DB Servers

As most of you would have already guessed, you CAN in fact use the EC2 machine configured in the previous chapter as a database server (although not a very good one with such minimal specs).

This is mostly similar to what we do today where we load a VM and then install the database (Oracle, MySQL etc) on it, then run it from within the VM. Let us take a look at how we can achieve this using the EC2 machine that we configured earlier.

Start by connecting via ssh to your machine:

- `ssh -i "test-t2-micro.pem" <user>@<instance.public.ip>`

Next, install one or more required dependencies.

For this example, we will try to install MySQL DB on the EC2 instance. To do this, we need to get the installer for MySQL from the official registry, the command for this is as follows:

- `> sudo yum localinstall http://repo.mysql.com/mysql-community-release-el6-3.noarch.rpm`
- `> sudo yum install mysql-community-server`

That's it! The `mysql-community-server` has been installed to your EC2 machine. To start the service, simply run

- `>sudo service mysqld start`

Your MySQL server should be running on the default port on this machine. You can connect to this using any client and the default user and password.

[Please note: The security group configured for this EC2 machine must allow traffic on the port the server is listening to, to check this, select the instance from EC2 console, click on "Actions">Networking>Security Groups]

Try connecting to the machine using any DB Client on port 3306 with username "root" and no password. You have now successfully set up a database that can be accessible as long as the EC2 machine is. This database can now be used in your application to store and retrieve data without worrying about downtime and bootups.

However, a few concerns remain. Nobody is taking backups for you, there are no database management jobs that are running for it, the indexes are not being rebuilt. In short, the database is not being administered properly, it just exists.